TRANSPUTEC

OCT 2026

100 UK BUSINESSES · ONE YEAR



The Resilience Gap.

Attacks have levelled off. Readiness has not caught up. A reading of the evidence for UK leaders.

TRANSPUTEC RESEARCH

SAMPLE EDITION

ABOUT THIS REPORT

Four sources. Every figure cited.

We did not run a survey for this report. We read the best public evidence available, put it side by side, and said plainly where a number comes from.

SOURCE 01

Cyber Security Breaches Survey 2025/26

UK Government (DSIT and the Home Office). The annual benchmark of how many businesses are attacked and how they respond. Published 30 April 2026.

SOURCE 02

Cost of a Data Breach Report 2025

IBM, with the Ponemon Institute. UK edition. Real breaches at 600 organisations, March 2024 to February 2025.

SOURCE 03

NCSC Annual Review 2025

The National Cyber Security Centre's account of the incidents it handled in the twelve months to August 2025.

SOURCE 04

Cyber Monitoring Centre

Independent assessment of the Jaguar Land Rover incident and its cost to the UK economy, October 2025.

HOW TO READ IT

Each source samples a different group of organisations over a different period, so we never add figures from separate sources together. Superscript numbers refer to the sources on page 14. Where we give a view rather than a fact, it is marked **Our view**.

This is a design sample. Layout, voice and structure are final; the Transputec Resilience Model on page 11 is illustrative.

© 2026 Transputec Ltd. All rights reserved. Third-party figures remain the property of their publishers and are quoted with attribution.

CONTENTS

Inside.

Foreword 04

Executive summary 05

01 The shape of the threat 06

02 What a breach costs 08

03 When it becomes national news 09

04 The preparedness gap 10

05 A model for resilience 11

06 Where to start 12

07 What good looks like 13

Sources and method 14

FOREWORD

Most IT leaders are not short of warnings. They are short of time, and of a clear view of what comes first.

This report is our attempt at that view. We went back to the public evidence (the government's annual survey, the National Cyber Security Centre, IBM's research on breach costs and the independent analysis of last year's biggest UK incidents) and set it side by side.

Two things stand out. The first is that the number of businesses being hit has stopped climbing. It has held at 43% for two years running. The second is harder to read: preparedness has barely moved. Three in four businesses still have no formal plan for the day something goes wrong.

We work with organisations that run on very little spare attention. What they ask of us is rarely another tool. They want a calmer operation, a cost they can predict, and a straight answer when something breaks.

We hope this report makes the case for that kind of resilience on the evidence rather than on fear. Read it for the figures. Use the playbook that accompanies it for the next ninety days.

The Transputec team

LONDON · OCTOBER 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The threat has levelled off. The gap has not closed.

43%

of UK businesses reported a breach or attack in the past year[1]

£3.78

m average UK breach cost without extensive security automation, against £3.11m with it[2]

204

nationally significant incidents handled by the NCSC, up from 89[3]

25%

of businesses have a formal incident response plan[1]

What the evidence says

Attack volume is flat, but the incidents that land are larger. The NCSC handled more than twice as many nationally significant incidents as the year before, and one manufacturing outage cost the UK economy an estimated £1.9 billion.[3,4]

Cost follows speed. UK organisations that used security automation widely found and contained breaches 42 days sooner and saved about £670,000 per breach.[2]

What it means

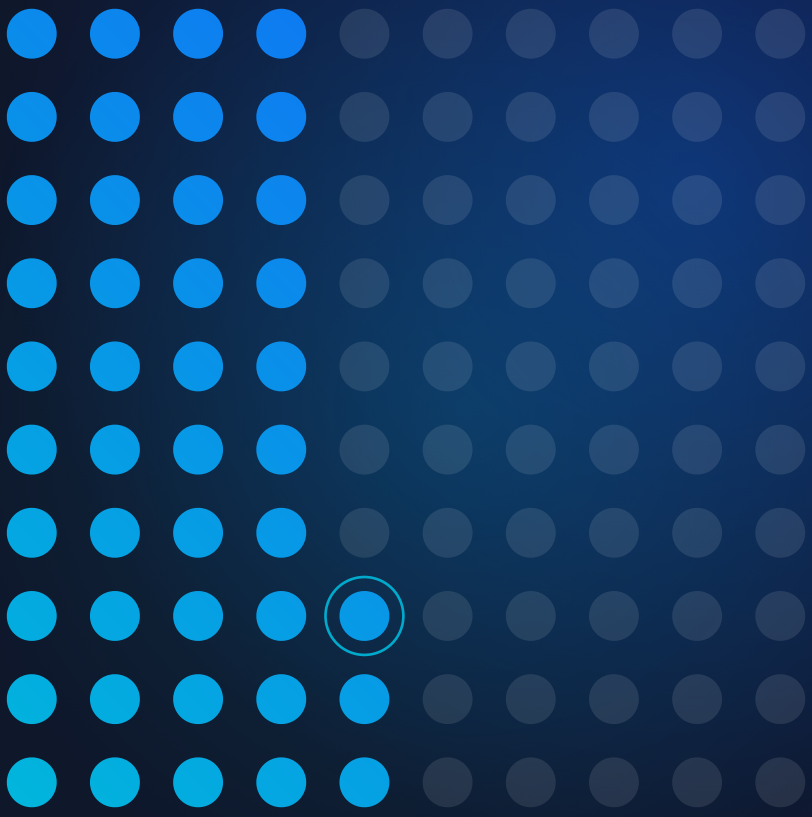
The gap is no longer awareness. It is practice: rehearsed recovery, a view of supplier risk, and rules for the AI tools staff already use. Each is cheaper to build before an incident than during one.

Our view: resilience is an operating discipline with a budget line, not a project with an end date.

FIVE MOVES — Know what matters · Close the front door · Rehearse recovery · Govern AI and suppliers · Report to the board in numbers

CHAPTER 01

The shape of the threat.



EVERY DOT, ONE UK BUSINESS IN 100

43%

of UK businesses reported a cyber breach or attack in the last twelve months. About 612,000 organisations.[1]

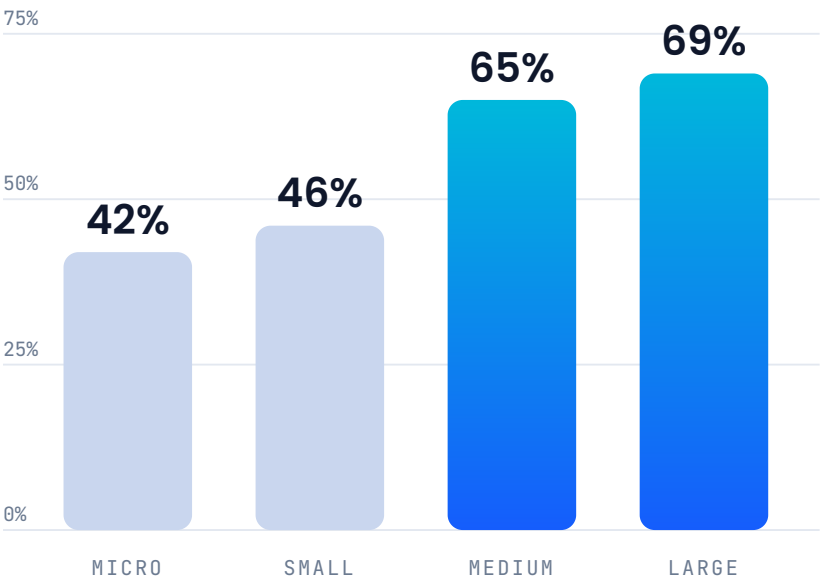
01

01 · THE SHAPE OF THE THREAT

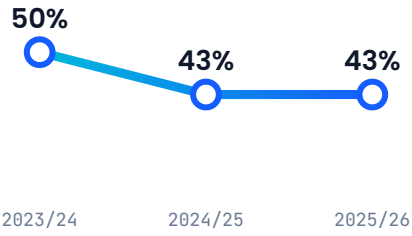
Size changes the odds. Nobody is exempt.

Two in three medium-sized and large businesses reported a breach or attack. Among micro businesses the figure was still above four in ten.[1]

SHARE REPORTING A BREACH OR ATTACK, BY BUSINESS SIZE



ALL BUSINESSES, OVER TIME



Down from half of businesses in 2023/24, then flat for two years.[1]

38%

Phishing

of businesses faced at least one phishing attack. It remains the most common type, and the one most often named as the most disruptive.[1]

1%

Ransomware

of businesses reported it, down from 3% in each of the two previous years. Reports are low, but the impact when it lands is not.[1]

5%

Lost revenue

of businesses said a breach cost them revenue or share value, up from 2% the year before.[1]

Source: DSIT and Home Office, Cyber Security Breaches Survey 2025/26.

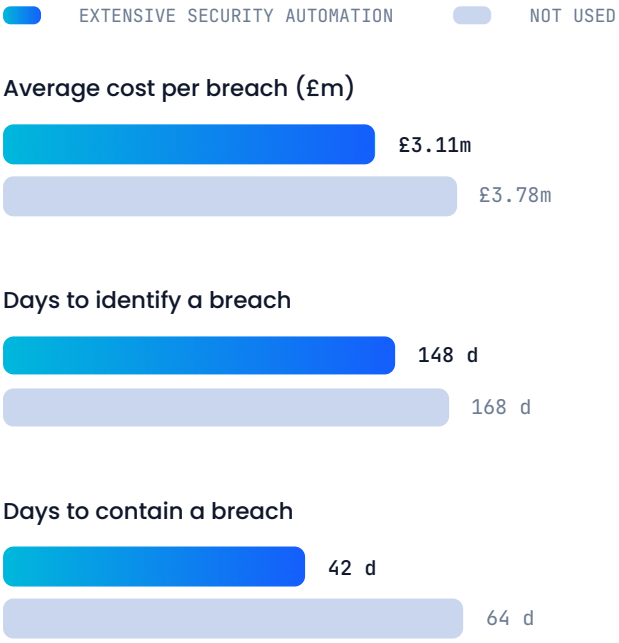
THE RESILIENCE GAP · 01 · THE SHAPE OF THE THREAT

02

02 · WHAT A BREACH COSTS

Speed is the cheapest control there is.

UK organisations that used security AI and automation across their operations paid £3.11 million per breach. Those that did not paid £3.78 million.[2]



WHERE UK BREACHES START

Supplier or supply chain	18%
Phishing	16%
Compromised credentials	11%

Most commonly reported causes among UK respondents.[2]

£5.74m

average UK breach cost in financial services, the costliest sector.[2]

£498k

extra paid by organisations with high levels of unsanctioned AI use.[2]

<1 in 3

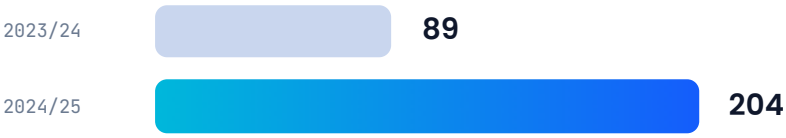
UK organisations use security automation extensively. The saving is on the table.[2]

Source: IBM, Cost of a Data Breach Report 2025, UK edition. 600 organisations worldwide, March 2024 to February 2025.

03 · WHEN IT BECOMES NATIONAL NEWS

Four a week, and one that cost the economy £1.9 billion.

NCSC · NATIONALLY SIGNIFICANT INCIDENTS



429
incidents handled[3]

18
highly significant, up 50%[3]

Twelve months to August 2025. The NCSC describes this as the third consecutive year of increase in the most serious category.[3]

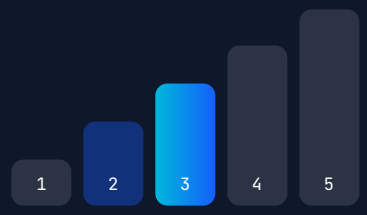
ALSO ASSESSED · CMC CATEGORY 2

Marks & Spencer
Co-op
Harrods[4]

CASE · JAGUAR LAND ROVER

£1.9bn

Estimated cost to the UK economy, the most economically damaging cyber event in the country's history. About 5,000 organisations were affected, most through halted production at JLR and its suppliers.[4]



OUR VIEW

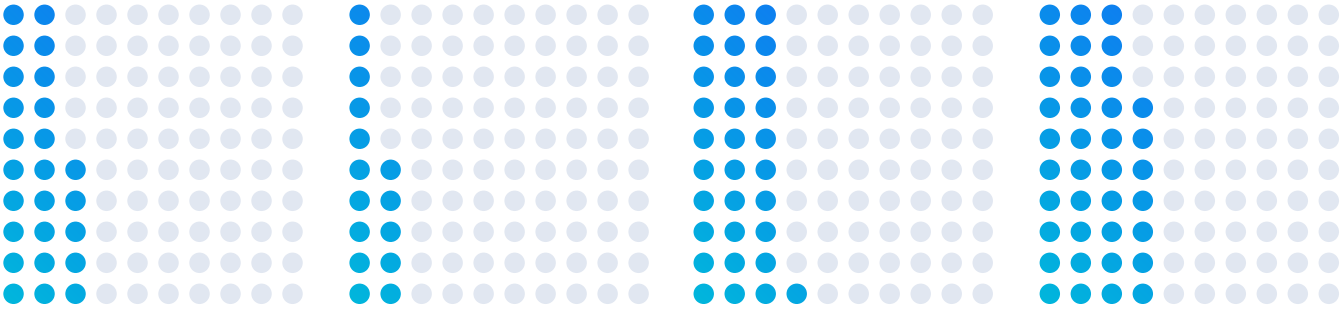
What links the large incidents is not novelty. It is dependence: a handful of systems, suppliers or logins that the business could not run without, and no rehearsed way to run without them.

Sources: NCSC Annual Review 2025; Cyber Monitoring Centre. The JLR estimate assumes a return to normal by January 2026.

04 · THE PREPAREDNESS GAP

Knowing the risk is not the same as being ready.

Picture 100 organisations in each case. The lit dots are the ones that have done the thing.



25%
have a formal incident response plan[1]

15%
review the risk from their immediate suppliers[1]

31%
of UK organisations govern AI use with policies[2]

37%
of UK organisations have AI access controls in place[2]

Columns 1–2: DSIT, businesses. Columns 3–4: IBM, UK respondents (63% report no AI access controls). Different populations; not additive.

A plan on paper

Having a document is the start. The organisations that recover quickly have run the plan: someone has been woken at 2am, the phone tree has been tried, and the backups have been restored somewhere other than the lab.

Suppliers are the blind spot

Supplier compromise was the most common cause of UK breaches in IBM's data, yet only 15% of businesses review supplier risk.[1,2]

AI arrived first, rules second

Staff are already using AI tools. Fewer than a third of UK organisations have rules for it, and breaches involving heavy unsanctioned use cost £498,000 more.[2]

OUR VIEW

The gap is cheap to close and expensive to discover. It is closed with rehearsal and ownership, not with another purchase.

05 · A MODEL FOR RESILIENCE

Five disciplines. One operating rhythm.

The Transputec Resilience Model organises the evidence into five things an organisation does continuously. Each one answers a gap on the previous pages.

01

Know

WHAT MATTERS MOST

Critical systems and data mapped

Owners named for each

Dependencies on suppliers listed

You cannot protect or restore what you have not listed.

02

Protect

CLOSE THE FRONT DOOR

Multi-factor sign-in everywhere

Email filtering and user training

Devices patched and managed

Phishing reached 38% of businesses.[1]

03

Detect

SEE IT EARLY

24/7 monitoring of identity and endpoints

Alerts that people act on

Defined escalation paths

Faster identification cut containment by 42 days.[2]

04

Recover

REHEARSE, THEN RELY

Backups restored on a schedule

Incident plan exercised twice a year

Recovery time agreed in the contract

Only 25% have a formal plan.[1]

05

Govern

MAKE IT A BOARD TOPIC

Supplier risk reviewed yearly

AI use under written rules

A one-page scorecard each quarter

Supplier compromise led UK causes at 18%.[2]

ILLUSTRATIVE

The model is Transputec's own framing, built from the sources in this report. It is a starting structure, not a certification or a standard.

06 · WHERE TO START

Find your stage. Take the next one.

Read down each column and count the statements that are true today without qualification. Your stage is the highest one where you can tick every line.

A

Reactive

We fix what breaks.

- No written incident plan
- Backups exist, restores untested
- Sign-in protection is patchy

B

Managed

Someone owns it.

- Named owner for IT risk
- MFA across the business
- Monitoring during office hours

C

Resilient

We have practised.

- Plan exercised twice a year
- Backups restored on schedule
- 24/7 monitoring and response

D

Assured

We can show it.

- Supplier risk reviewed yearly
- AI use under written rules
- Quarterly board scorecard

MOVING UP

Most of the distance between A and C is rehearsal and ownership, which cost time rather than licences. The step from C to D is where a managed partner earns its fee: evidence, supplier reviews and a board pack someone else prepares.

Our view: do not skip a stage. An assured organisation that has never restored a backup is not assured.

07 · WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

Resilience you can check, and contract.

Transputec delivers managed IT for UK businesses on a fixed monthly fee, with service levels written into the agreement. These are the figures we report, and the credentials behind them.[5]

30%+
lower run-cost than the equivalent in-house team

NPS 70+
across managed users

78%
first-call resolution, rapid phone answer

1,000+
projects delivered

ACCREDITATIONS AND PARTNERSHIPS

LRQA CERTIFIED · LRQA CERTIFIED ISO 14001 · CYBER ESSENTIALS CERTIFIED PLUS · OFFENSIVE SECURITY OSCP

Microsoft Solutions Partner — Modern Work

Microsoft Solutions Partner — Security

aws PARTNER Advanced Tier Services

CISCO Partner

DELL Technologies GOLD PARTNER

Lenovo 360 Gold 2026

mimecast premier partner

cloudtango

Government Commercial Agency *Supplier*

Government Commercial Agency G-Cloud 15 and TePAS 2 [RM6098] supplier (Lots 2, 3 and 8) · Data Protection registered · PCR Awards 2023 · Prestige Awards 2023 · ISO 27001-certified delivery from a UK service desk.[5]

Source: Transputec, transputec.com, accessed 27 October 2026. Company-reported; not independently audited.

SOURCES AND METHOD

Where the numbers come from.

1 Department for Science, Innovation and Technology and Home Office. **Cyber Security Breaches Survey 2025/26.** Official statistics, published 30 April 2026. gov.uk.

Used for: Prevalence by size, phishing, ransomware, revenue loss, incident response plans, supplier review.

2 IBM. **Cost of a Data Breach Report 2025, UK edition** (Ponemon Institute). Press release: uk.newsroom.ibm.com/2025-cost-of-data-breach-UK

Used for: UK breach cost, identification and containment times, causes, shadow AI, AI governance.

3 National Cyber Security Centre. **NCSC Annual Review 2025.** Incident management chapter. ncsc.gov.uk/collection/ncsc-annual-review-2025

Used for: 429 incidents, 204 nationally significant, 18 highly significant.

4 Cyber Monitoring Centre. **Assessment of the Jaguar Land Rover cyber event,** 22 October 2025, as reported by Infosecurity Magazine: infosecurity-magazine.com/news/jlr-hack-uk-costliest-ever-19bn/

Used for: £1.9bn estimate, Category 3, c.5,000 organisations; M&S, Co-op, Harrods at Category 2.

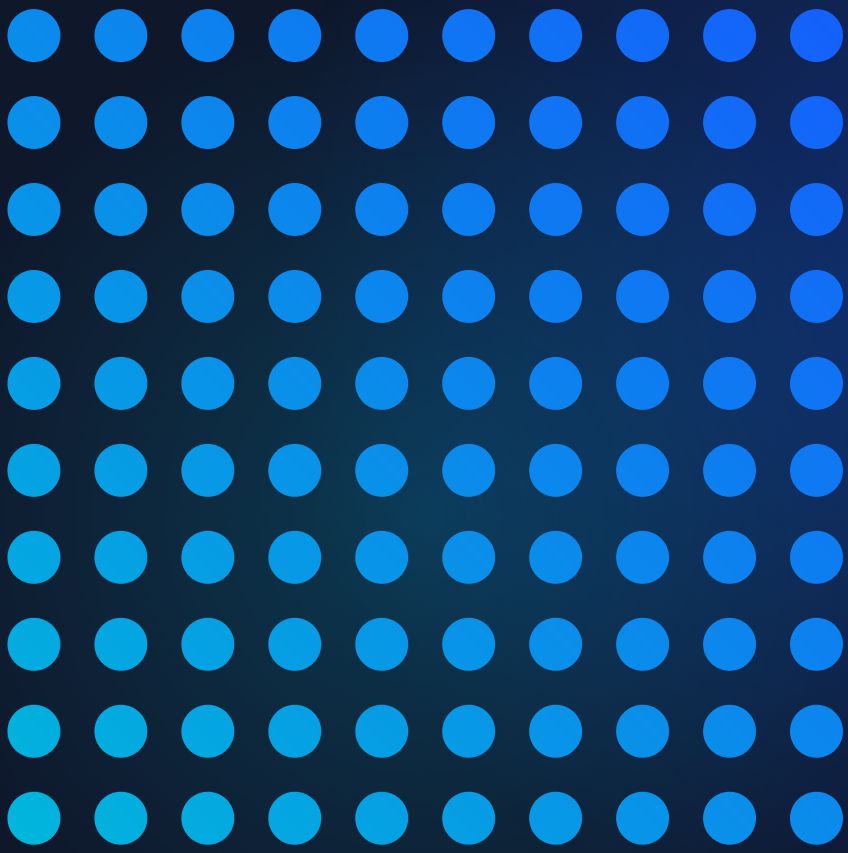
5 Transputec. **transputec.com,** accessed 27 October 2026.

Used for: Company-reported service figures.

METHOD NOTES

Figures are reproduced as published. We have rounded nothing except where a source itself rounds. The DSIT survey reports what organisations identified and chose to disclose, so true prevalence is likely higher. IBM's UK figures come from a subset of its global sample and are indicative. The JLR estimate depends on assumptions about recovery timing that the CMC states in its assessment.

Cross-source comparisons are avoided by design. We have not modelled or extrapolated any figure.



100 OF 100 · THE GAP, CLOSED

TRANSPUTEC

Managed IT services for UK businesses,
powered by AI.

LRQA CERTIFIED · LRQA CERTIFIED ISO 14001 · CYBER ESSENTIALS CERTIFIED PLUS · OFFENSIVE SECURITY OSCP · Microsoft Solutions Partner Modern Work · Microsoft Solutions Partner Security · aws PARTNER Advanced Tier Services · CISCO Partner